

# Nicolas Wessler

Ph.D. Candidate, UBC Sauder School of Business  
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## Research Interests

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International Trade, Political Economy, Economic History

## Education

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| <b>University of British Columbia</b> , Sauder School of Business        | 2021 - present |
| Ph.D. in Strategy and Business Economics                                 |                |
| Committee: Keith Head, Ayumu Ken Kikkawa, Nathan Nunn                    |                |
| Advanced Studies Program, Kiel Institute for the World Economy (Germany) | 2018 - 2019    |
| Master of Science in Economics, University of Pavia (Italy)              | 2017 - 2018    |
| Master of Science in Economics, University of Tübingen (Germany)         | 2016 - 2017    |
| Visiting Student, Kasetsart University (Thailand)                        | 2015 - 2016    |
| Bachelor of Science in Economics, University of Münster (Germany)        | 2012 - 2016    |

## Research and Work Experience

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| <b>Pre-Doctoral Research Associate</b> , University of Chicago                        | 2019 - 2021 |
| Prof. Felix Tintelnot & Prof. Alessandra González                                     |             |
| <b>Research Assistant</b> , United Nations ESCAP (Thailand)                           | 2019        |
| <b>Research Assistant</b> , Prof. Andreas Fuchs, Kiel Institute for the World Economy | 2018 - 2019 |
| <b>Intern</b> , Economic Policy Forum (Germany)                                       | 2016        |

## Awards and Scholarships

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| UBC Killam Graduate Teaching Award (\$1,000)                                         | 2025/2026   |
| ReCIPE PhD Research Grant, UK Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office (£15,000) | 2025        |
| EDI Research Catalyst Funding, UBC Dhillon Centre (\$1,000)                          | 2024        |
| Doctoral Recruitment Fellowship, UBC Sauder School of Business                       | 2021 - 2026 |
| ASP Scholarship, Kiel Institute for the World Economy                                | 2018 - 2019 |
| DAAD Full Year Scholarship                                                           | 2017        |

## Working Papers

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**The Cost of Rivalry: Geopolitical Fragmentation and Trade during the Cold War**

(with Timothy Meyer, *Job Market Paper*)

Selected for the 2026 Macroeconomic Policy Perspectives Conference and invited for submission to the Journal of Political Economy (JPE) Macroeconomics special issue.

## Hegemonic Competition with Carrots and Sticks

(with Timothy Meyer)

## Publications

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### Trade Reliance and the Success of Economic Sanctions

*Review of World Economics*, 2026, [link](#)

### The Glass Web: Kinship Networks, Female Executives and Firm Outcomes in the Middle East

(with Alessandra L. González)

*Economics of Transition and Institutional Change*, 2026, Art. ecot.70037, [link](#)

## Presentations

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### 2026

- **Oct** — The Third Annual Macroeconomic Policy Perspectives Conference, Stanford (JMP, forthcoming)
- **Jul** — NBER Summer Institute on International Economics and Geopolitics\*
- **Jul** — 8th International Conference on European Economics and Politics, ETH Zurich (JMP)
- **Jun** — Cowles Summer Conference on International Trade, Yale (JMP)
- **Apr** — 24th Annual GEP/CEPR Postgrad Conference, Nottingham (JMP)

### 2025

- **Sep** — Philly Trade Group at Drexel, Philadelphia
- **May** — 59th Annual Meetings of the Canadian Economics Association, Montreal
- **May** — Second Annual Workshop on Sanctions, Vienna
- **Feb** — Graduate Student International Political Economy Conference, Berkeley

### 2024

- **May** — Research in International Economics and Finance Doctoral Meeting, Paris
- **May** — 58th Annual Meetings of the CEA, Toronto

(JMP): Job Market Paper presentation    \*: Presented by co-author

## Referee Services

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Review of World Economics

Review of International Economics

## Other Services

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President, UBC Sauder Ph.D. Student Society

2024

Organizer, UBC Trade/Spatial Brownbag Seminar Series

2024

## Teaching Experience

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### University of British Columbia — Instructor

COMM 394: Environment, Society and Government (Undergraduate)

Summer 2025

Enrollment: 36 students   Teaching load: 6 hrs/week   Teaching evaluation: 4.9 / 5.0

### University of British Columbia — Teaching Assistant

COMR 493: Strategic Management in Business (Undergraduate)

Winter 2024, Winter 2023

COMR 491: Strategic Management (Undergraduate)

Winter 2023

COEC 498: Advanced International Business Management (Undergraduate)

Winter 2023

COMM 498: International Business Management (Undergraduate)

Winter 2022

ECON 455: International Trade (Undergraduate)

Winter 2022, Winter 2023

## Skills

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**Languages:** English (fluent), German (native), Italian (beginner)

**Software:** R, Stata, Python, Julia, MATLAB

## Other Information

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Born: September 1992

Citizenship: Germany

## References

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### Keith Head

Sauder School of Business, UBC

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### Ayumu Ken Kikkawa

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### Nathan Nunn

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